The Money Decisions on the Table

A worksheet for what your family has done, is considering and has been told about Mom's money.

“We should pay your brother back.” “We could sell the car.” “Someone said to look at an annuity.” Each one came up in a different conversation, and none of them is written down.

Fill this in with what you know. Write what happened or what was said, with the date and who was involved, and put a question beside each line instead of an answer. If you don't know something, write “don't know” and leave it.

What Mom's care costs, and what is paying for it

From the latest bill and the statements: what her care costs each month, what comes in each month, and which account pays the rest. Use the papers, not memory.

FOR EXAMPLE The care bill comes at the start of the month. Her Social Security and a small pension go into checking. The rest comes out of her savings. I'd have to look at the statement for the amount.

What we've been told, and who said it

The rules people have offered about what has to be spent, what should be moved and what is safe. Write each one the way you heard it. None of them is settled yet.

FOR EXAMPLE A coworker of David's: “It all has to be spent before Medicaid will help.” A neighbor: “You should move her money.” Question for both: is that so in Mom's state, for her situation?

Money decisions already made

Gifts, repayments, sales, a change of name on an account, anything paid for with Mom's money beyond her usual bills. What it was, who was involved, and the date as best you know it. A line here doesn't mean anything was wrong. It means a professional can see it.

FOR EXAMPLE In the spring Mom paid Karen back for the furnace repair. Not sure of the date; the check will be on the statement. Question: what would a professional want to see about this?

Money decisions being considered

Anything the family is talking about: repaying a relative, selling something, changing ownership, a financial product someone has suggested. Mark each one “being discussed.”

FOR EXAMPLE Being discussed: selling Mom's car. Being discussed: an annuity a friend of Karen's mentioned. Question for each: what would need to be reviewed before we do anything?

What we don't know yet

Dates you can't pin down, papers you can't find, things only one relative knows about. Don't guess.

FOR EXAMPLE Don't know whether Mom still has the life insurance policy from her old job. Don't know whose name is on the car title.

Who filled this in, and on which date

What this shows you

Three things: what your family has been told, what has already been done, and what is still only an idea, each with a question beside it. It doesn't show whether anything on the page is allowed or what it may mean for Medicaid, and nothing here adds up to a score. How each line is treated depends on Mom's state and her situation, so the questions go to your Medicaid planner, an elder law attorney, or a licensed insurance or financial professional. Nothing here is legal, financial or tax advice.

Ready for the next step?

You've written down the decisions your family has made and the ones still on the table, each with a question beside it. The planning interview asks about the rest of your family's situation and gives you a free planning report to bring, along with this worksheet, to your Medicaid planner.

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